

Some of the common operations on files are summarized in Figure 4.12.

open(fn, 'w') fn is a string representing a file name. Creates a file for writing and returns a file handle.

open(fn, 'r') fn is a string representing a file name. Opens an existing file for reading and returns a file handle.

open(fn, 'a') fn is a string representing a file name. Opens an existing file for appending and returns a file handle.

fh.read() returns a string containing the contents of the file associated with the file handle fh.

fh.readline() returns the next line in the file associated with the file handle fh.

fh.readlines() returns a list each element of which is one line of the file associated with the file handle fh.

fh.write(s) writes the string s to the end of the file associated with the file handle fh.

fh.writelines(S) S is a sequence of strings. Writes each element of S as a separate line to the file associated with the file handle fh.

fh.close() closes the file associated with the file handle fh.

Figure 4.12 Common functions for accessing files